PEER REVIEW HISTORY

BMJ Open publishes all reviews undertaken for accepted manuscripts. Reviewers are asked to complete a checklist review form (**http://bmjopen.bmj.com/site/about/resources/checklist.pdf**) and are provided with free text boxes to elaborate on their assessment. These free text comments are reproduced below.

ARTICLE DETAILS

TITLE (PROVISIONAL)	The impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on the mental health and learning of college and university students: a protocol of systematic review and meta-analysis
AUTHORS	Mao, Jing; Gao, Xin; Yan, Peireng; Ren, Xiaocao; Guan, Yong; Yan, Yi

VERSION 1 – REVIEW

REVIEWER	Arnout, B King Khalid University
REVIEW RETURNED	25-Nov-2020

GENERAL COMMENTS	Thank you for sharing your important work. please, add study question, limitations, and also future directions for the researchers. As well as, you can draw a dev

REVIEWER	Santabarbara, Javier University of Zaragoza Faculty of Medicine, Preventice Medicine
REVIEW RETURNED	16-Dec-2020

GENERAL COMMENTS	Thank you for the opportunity to review the manuscript entitled " The impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on the mental health and learning of college and university students: a protocol of systematic review and meta-analysis" in BMJ Open. This work represents an important area of inquiry that is relevant to the readership of this journal. The statistical analyses were well designed, although why the authors omitted meta-regression analysis?. I applaud the use of STATA software and PRISMA-P guidelines. This is an interesting manuscript, but I have several issues the authors should address before publication can be considered: The authors have avoided meta-analysis of anxiety and depression in the general population (Bueno-Notivol et al., 2020; Santabárbara et al., 2020) and in specific populations (Lasheras et al., 2020) that should be included in the introductory, and even discussion, sections References: Bueno-Notivol, J., Gracia-García, P., Olaya, B., Lasheras, I., López-Antón, R., Santabárbara, J., 2020. Prevalence of depression during the COVID-19 outbreak: A meta-analysis of community-

	based studies. Int. J. Clin. Heal. Psychol. https://doi.org/https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ijchp.2020.07.007 J.Santabárbara,I.Lasheras,D.M.Lipnicki,etal.,Prevalenceofanxietyin theCOVID-19 pandemic: An updated meta-analysis of community-based studies, Progression Neuropsychopharmacology & Biological Psychiatry(2019), https://doi.org/10.1016/j.pnpbp.2020.110207 (in press). Lasheras, I.; Gracia-García, P.; Lipnicki, D.M.; Bueno-Notivol, J.; López-Antón, R.; de la Cámara, C.; Lobo, A.; Santabárbara, J. Prevalence of Anxiety in Medical Students during the COVID-19 Pandemic: A Rapid Systematic Review with Meta-Analysis. Int. J. Environ. Res. Public Health 2020, 17, 6603.

VERSION 1 – AUTHOR RESPONSE

Replies to Reviewers

Reviewer: 1
Thank you for sharing your important work.
please, add study question, limitations, and also future directions for the researchers. As well as, you can draw a dev
Response: Thanks for your insightful comments. We have added the study question in the Review question section in the revised manuscript (before Methods section) (P7). We have modified the limitations, added future directions for the researchers and other information in the Discussion section in the revised manuscript (P12-P13).

Reviewer: 2
Thank you for the opportunity to review the manuscript entitled " The impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on the mental health and learning of college and university students: a protocol of systematic review and meta-analysis" in BMJ Open. This work represents an important area of inquiry that is relevant to the readership of this journal.

The statistical analyses were well designed, although why the authors omitted meta-regression analysis? I applaud the use of STATA software and PRISMA-P guidelines.
Response: Many thanks for your comments. We have added the meta-regression in the last paragraph of the Data synthesis and meta-analysis for Methods section in the revised manuscript (P11).

This is an interesting manuscript, but I have several issues the authors should address before publication can be considered:

The authors have avoided meta-analysis of anxiety and depression in the general population (Bueno-Notivol et al., 2020 Santabárbara et al., 2020) and in specific populations (Lasheras et al., 2020) that should be included in the introductory, and even discussion, sections

References:

Bueno-Notivol, J., Gracia-García, P., Olaya, B., Lasheras, I., López-Antón, R., Santabárbara, J., 2020. Prevalence of depression during the COVID-19 outbreak: A meta-analysis of community-based studies. Int. J. Clin. Heal. Psychol. https://doi.org/https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ijchp.2020.07.007

J.Santabárbara,I.Lasheras,D.M.Lipnicki,etal.,PrevalenceofanxietyintheCOVID-19 pandemic: An updated meta-analysis of community-based studies, Progression Neuropsychopharmacology & Biological Psychiatry(2019), https://doi.org/10.1016/j.pnpbp.2020.110207 (in press).

Lasheras, I. Gracia-García, P. Lipnicki, D.M. Bueno-Notivol, J. López-Antón, R. de la Cámara, C. Lobo, A. Santabárbara, J. Prevalence of Anxiety in Medical Students during the COVID-19 Pandemic: A Rapid Systematic Review with Meta-Analysis. Int. J. Environ. Res. Public Health 2020, 17, 6603.
Response: Thanks so much for your suggestion. We have added the three references and other related references in the introduction section (P5-P7) and first paragraph of discussion sections (P12). The three references were Ref 11, Ref 12 and Ref 15 in the revised manuscript.